GCP Budget Alert — Status + Setup (Amna's doc — Item 13)

Date: 2026-08-17 **Project:** `nelc-elearning-platform-479319` **Billing account:** `01BD47-E71367-C30EBC`

Current status

❌ **No programmatic budget currently exists.**

Verification (2026-08-17): the `billingbudgets.googleapis.com` API is **not enabled** on the project, which means:

- No budget has been created via API / gcloud / Terraform
- A budget may still exist in the console UI (older console-created budgets sit outside the API), but it can only be verified from the console by an Owner-level account

Ghulam cannot verify or create budgets from a developer account — this requires `billing.budgets.create` on the billing account, which is Owner-only.

What Amna must do

This is a **client-owner action**. The developer cannot proceed.

Step 1 — Check whether a budget already exists in the console

1. Open https://console.cloud.google.com/billing/01BD47-E71367-C30EBC/budgets
2. If a budget is listed → note the amount + threshold + recipients. Done.
3. If nothing is listed → proceed to Step 2.

Step 2 — Create a new budget

1. Same page → click **"Create Budget"**
2. **Scope:** Choose "Filter by project" → select `nelc-elearning-platform-479319`
3. **Amount:** Recommended **1,000 SAR / month** (≈ 2× the current ~515 SAR/month estimate — see `cost-tally.md`). This gives a comfortable buffer while still surfacing runaway costs quickly.
4. **Thresholds (recommended):**
   - 50% (500 SAR) — informational
   - 90% (900 SAR) — warning
   - 100% (1,000 SAR) — critical
   - 120% (1,200 SAR) — overspend alert
5. **Alert recipients:** Amna's client-owned email address(es). Do **NOT** include developer emails after handover.
6. Save.

Step 3 — Verify programmatic API is enabled (for future automation)

While in the console, also enable `billingbudgets.googleapis.com` on the project if not already:

```
gcloud services enable billingbudgets.googleapis.com --project=nelc-elearning-platform-479319
```

This lets Amna (or a future developer with the right role) list / update budgets via `gcloud billing budgets list --billing-account=01BD47-E71367-C30EBC`.

Recommended budget rationale

Current monthly estimate: ~515 SAR (see `cost-tally.md` breakdown).

Budget option	Monthly amount	Trade-off
Tight	600 SAR	Fires at 90% almost every month if any usage spikes → alert fatigue
Recommended	**1,000 SAR**	**~2× current spend. Fires only when something is genuinely wrong.**
Loose	2,000 SAR	Only catches catastrophic runaway (accidentally-triggered infinite loop, GCE VM left on)

The middle option gives Amna room to add moderate new features (e.g., ~200 SAR/mo of new AI-generated content, or a Cloud SQL upgrade from db-g1-small to a bigger tier) without immediately having to bump the budget.

Documentation update after budget is created

Once Amna has confirmed or created the budget, this file should be updated to record:

- ✅ Budget amount confirmed: _____ SAR/month
- ✅ Thresholds: _____ %
- ✅ Alert recipients: _____ (**must not include developer emails**)
- ✅ Confirmed by: Amna, on _____ (date)
- ✅ `billingbudgets.googleapis.com` enabled: Yes / No

Then this row in the handover matrix can flip from **"Requires Client Action"** → **"Completed"**.